

Dad's Cancer Scare

“5 year rate”

Maybe they're talking finance?

(the word “survival” cleverly cleaved)

“DRE”

“This is what gets me”

Why the worried whispers?

“The kids can't know”

But this “kid” is pushing 20.

“PSA levels”

The smoking gun.

(But no fingerprints on the trigger)

And then: sleepless nights

(Both he and I, on opposite sides of the house)

devouring medical literature,

annotating scientific papers.

I have reclaimed my control.

(Silly girl, you have none)